

STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

SENATE
RESOLUTION 38

By: Paxton

AS INTRODUCED

A Resolution recognizing Joseph Castiglione.

WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione concluded his 28 years as the University of Oklahoma's Vice President and Director of Athletics in February 2026, the longest tenure among Football Bowl Subdivision schools; and

WHEREAS, the past 28 years have represented an era of unmatched academic and athletics excellence by Sooner sports programs; and

WHEREAS, under Joseph Castiglione, nearly 3,000 student-athletes earned OU degrees; and

WHEREAS, under Joseph Castiglione, the Sooners won 117 conference titles and 26 of the University's 45 (or 58%) all-time national championships (nine by men's gymnastics, eight by softball, seven by women's gymnastics, and one each by football and men's golf); and

WHEREAS, OU Athletics enjoyed 28 consecutive terms of a cumulative GPA of 3.0 or higher and eight straight semesters of a

1 3.2 or higher under Joseph Castiglione's watch, with student
2 athletes setting a program-record 3.31 cumulative GPA during the
3 spring 2025 semester; and

4 WHEREAS, during OU's 26 years as a member of the Big 12
5 Conference while Joseph Castiglione served as the school's athletics
6 director, the Sooners amassed 15 Big 12 Athletes of the Year-more
7 than any other program; and

8 WHEREAS, four Sooners won Heisman Trophies during Joseph
9 Castiglione's tenure (Jason White in 2003, Sam Bradford in 2008,
10 Baker Mayfield in 2017, and Kyler Murray in 2018); and

11 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has added to the rich tradition of
12 coaching excellence at the University of Oklahoma with the hires of
13 exemplary coaches, including Bob Stoops, Oklahoma's all-time
14 winningest football coach; and

15 WHEREAS, during Joseph Castiglione's time as athletics director,
16 the football program won 14 Big 12 Conference championships (10 more
17 than the program with the next most) and the 2000 national title,
18 and the men's (two) and women's (three) basketball programs combined
19 for five Final Four appearances; and

20 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has hired and mentored dozens of
21 former employees who went on to serve as athletics directors and
22 senior-level administrators at other institutions; and

23 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has been a national leader in
24 collegiate athletics, including service on the College Football
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1 Playoff Committee and the NCAA Division I Men's Basketball and
2 Baseball committees, making him the first person in history to serve
3 on those three committees, in addition to many others; and

4 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione is a sought-after voice in
5 collegiate athletics who served on multiple NCAA committees and
6 commissions designed to improve the overall student athlete
7 experience; and

8 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione has demonstrated great leadership
9 through a range of challenges and opportunities, including the
10 creation of the Big 12 Conference and seismic conference realignment
11 with OU's move to the Southeastern Conference; and

12 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione ensured OU Athletics remained one of
13 the few self-sustaining departments in the country, making it a
14 model of fiscal responsibility and an engine of support for the
15 university at large; and

16 WHEREAS, the University of Oklahoma has enjoyed the renovation
17 and building of a variety of athletics facilities under Joseph
18 Castiglione's leadership, including a \$160 million renovation of the
19 Gaylord Family - Oklahoma Memorial Stadium and the construction of
20 Love's Field, Headington Family Tennis Center, Gregg Wadley Indoor
21 Tennis Pavilion, Griffin Family Performance Center for men's and
22 women's basketball, Headington Hall, and more; and

23 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione demonstrated his commitment to
24 excellence in the classroom by serving as an adjunct professor in
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1 OU's Jeannine Rainbolt College of Education, teaching graduate
2 courses in marketing and higher education leadership; and

3 WHEREAS, Joseph Castiglione is a seven-time National Athletics
4 Director of the Year who earned multiple additional honors,
5 including the National Football Foundation and College Football Hall
6 of Fame's prestigious John L. Toner Award and induction into the
7 Oklahoma Sports Hall of Fame, among others; and

8 WHEREAS, in his 28 years at OU, Joseph Castiglione provided
9 humble, steady leadership in a moment of unprecedented change and
10 disruption in collegiate athletics.

11 NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE 2ND SESSION
12 OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE:

13 THAT the Oklahoma State Senate recognizes the outstanding
14 contributions of Joseph Castiglione to the University of Oklahoma
15 and the State of Oklahoma.

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